THE WHOLE STORY · SMALL GROUP GUIDE · LESSON 1 OF 26

The Story Jesus Told

Luke 24:13–35, 44–47

> **The big idea:** The Bible is one story, and it is about Jesus. On the Emmaus road, Jesus opened the whole Old Testament and showed two confused disciples that it pointed to him.

Before you meet: Read

Luke 24:13–35 | Luke 24:44–47 | Genesis 2:8–10 | Revelation 22:1–5

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever tried to read the Bible on your own? Where did you get stuck, or what confused you?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

The two disciples were walking from Jerusalem to a village called _____, about seven miles away. *(Luke 24:13)*

"But we had _____ that he was the one to redeem Israel." *(Luke 24:21)*

"And beginning with _____ and all the Prophets, he interpreted to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning _____." *(Luke 24:27)*

They recognized Jesus when he took the _____, blessed and broke it, and gave it to them. *(Luke 24:30–31)*

"Did not our hearts _____ within us while he talked to us on the road?" *(Luke 24:32)*

Jesus said everything written about him in the Law of Moses and the Prophets and the _____ must be fulfilled. *(Luke 24:44)*

Discuss

1. Cleopas had all the facts about Jesus and still walked away sad. Why didn't the facts help him? *Luke 24:19–24*

2. "We had hoped." When have you been disappointed with God because he did not do what you expected? *Luke 24:21*

3. Jesus said the whole Old Testament is about him. What difference does that make in how you read Genesis or Leviticus? *Luke 24:27, 44*

4. Name the four acts of the Bible's story in your own words. Which one do people around you understand least? *Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration*

5. Read Genesis 2:8–10 and Revelation 22:1–5 side by side. What is the same? What is better at the end?

6. Their hearts burned while Jesus opened the Scriptures. What would it look like to come to this study expecting to meet him, and not only to learn about him? *Luke 24:32*

Apply this week

Get a Bible you can read and write your name in it. Read Luke 24 twice this week, and put a bookmark at Genesis 1, Luke 24, and Revelation 21. Before you read, pray, Lord, open my mind to understand the Scriptures (see Luke 24:45).

Memory verse

"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he interpreted to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself."

Luke 24:27

Pray

Thank God that the Bible is one story, and that he has written you into it through Jesus. Ask him to open your eyes as you read, the way he opened the eyes of the two disciples at the table.

LEADER NOTES · LESSON 1

The Story Jesus Told

Session plan (about 70 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Luke 24:13–35 aloud together. Then read 24:44–47.
10 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
30 min	Discuss: choose 4 of the 6 questions. Questions 1, 3, and 6 matter most.
5 min	Walk the group through the four acts (Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration) and the timeline in the full lesson.
10 min	Apply and pray. Introduce the memory verse and the reading for Lesson 2 (Genesis 1–2; Psalm 19).

Main points to land

1. The Bible is a library of sixty-six books that tells one story, and Jesus is its center (Luke 24:27, 44).
2. Knowing facts about Jesus is not the same as knowing him. Cleopas had the facts and missed the story.
3. The whole Bible fits into four acts: Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration. The ending (Revelation 22) answers the beginning (Genesis 2).
4. We are reading real history. The series follows a dated timeline from creation to the early church.
5. The goal of this study is to meet Christ, whose death and resurrection bring forgiveness to all who turn and trust him (Luke 24:47).

Core doctrine to teach

The Authority of Scripture

CORE DOCTRINE 1 OF 26 · SCRIPTURE ALONE

The Bible is God's own word, written by human authors as the Holy Spirit carried them along. It is true in all it teaches, and it is the final authority over everything we believe and do. Traditions, feelings, and experts are tested by Scripture, never the other way around. *2 Timothy 3:16–17; 2 Peter 1:20–21; Luke 24:27, 44*

Answer key (Observe)

1. Emmaus
2. hoped
3. Moses; himself
4. bread
5. burn
6. Psalms

Questions people will ask

Is the Old Testament really about Jesus, or are Christians reading him into it?
Jesus himself said it was about him (Luke 24:27, 44; John 5:39). Christians do not find Jesus in every verse the same way, but the whole Old Testament story, its promises, sacrifices, kings, and prophets, points forward to him. Augustine put it this way: the New is hidden in the Old, and the Old is made plain in the New.

Why didn't the disciples recognize Jesus?
Luke says "their eyes were kept from recognizing him" (24:16). God held back their recognition until Jesus had first shown them the meaning of the Scriptures. The point is that we come to know Jesus through his Word.

Do we have to believe the earth is about six thousand years old?
The series follows the Bible's numbers at face value, but faithful Christians, including Reformed ones, have read the early chapters of Genesis in more than one way. What is not negotiable is that God created everything, that Adam was a real man, and that the fall was a real event. Keep the group on the main point.

I'm not sure I believe this yet. Can I still come?
Yes. Jesus was patient with two slow, confused disciples. Encourage honest questions, and point people to Jesus himself, not to the group's opinions.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you that your Word is one true story and that Jesus is at the center of it. As we begin this study, open our minds to understand the Scriptures, make our hearts burn as we read, and bring each of us to know your Son, who died and rose for us. Amen.